Social Media Marketing

Target Audience Segmentation

Summary Notes

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Lesson objectives

- Target audience segmentation
- Buyer persona development
- Purchase drivers
- Targeted content
- Uses for buyer personas

Fun Fact

DID YOU KNOW: The buyer persona was originally developed by software designer and programmer Alan Cooper. He is widely recognised as the Father Visual Basic.

Target Audience Segmentation

One of the most commonly applied marketing methods practiced in modern marketing previously most marketing approaches were based around products and product differentiation from competitor rather than on the customer. However, with all the online noise – focusing on your customer is the way to get ahead.

STP method/approach:

S - Segmentation: segmenting your audience based on various demographic andpsychographic factors
T - Targeting: selecting the target market
P - Positioning: positioning your product for that specific market

Benefits of Target Audience Segmenation

Personalised content
It helps you to develop and deliver personalised and relevant content to more commercially appealing audiences – ie – high quality leads who are more likely to convert.

Effective communication
Leads to effective communication as you are able to select the most valuable segments for your business and hen develop your marketing mix and position your product for each segment.

Target niche markets
Identify niches with specific needs.

Target mature markets
Target more mature markets to find new customers and deliver more focused and effective marketing messages.

Demographic and Psychographic Audience Segmentations

Demographics
Broken down into age, gender, income, education, ethnicity, marital status, education, household, profession.

Psychographics
Personality and behavioural traits – linked to purchase choices including attitudes, lifestyle, hobbies, risk aversion, personality.

Lifestyle
Hobbies, recreational pursuits, entertainment, vacations.

Beliefs and values
Religious, political, nationalistic, cultural.

Life stages
Chronological benchmarking of lives: primary school, high school, college, work, get married, have kids, retire, etc.

Geography
Drill down by country, region, area, population density.

Behaviour
Nature of purchase: brand loyalty, usage level, benefits sought, distribution channels used, reaction to marketing factors.

Benefit
Use and satisfaction gained from product use.

Buyer persona recap

A buyer persona is a semi-fictional representation of your ideal customer based on market research and real data about your existing customer

Purchase Drivers

What drives purchases? Want OR Need.

People want to gain:

- Health
- Self confidence
- Time
- Improved appearance
- Comfort
- Leisure
- Enjoyment

People want to save:

- Time
- Discomfort
- Risks
- Money
- Worry
- Embarrassment
- Doubt

People want to be:

- Efficient
- Up-to-date
- First
- Proud of their possessions
- Influential

People want to:

- Express themselves
- Appreciate beauty
- Improve themselves

Segmenting your Target Audience

Step 1:

Define your target audience

Step 2:

Break down your audience into smaller age segments

Step 3:

Break them down further into male and female personas

Step 4:

Complete information that you have from target audience:

- Age
- Gender
- Education
- Average income
- Lifestyle
- Hobbies and interests

Step 5:

Add information based on data analysis from Google Analytics and social media networks. The additional information that you can get and expand on certain buyer persona points include:

- Occupation
- Average income
- Marital status
- Hobbies and interests
- Platforms
- Devices

Step 6:

Complete any additional information with market research. Market research can be conducted through online polls, surveys, focus groups, one-on-one interviews and phone surveys. All information can be expanded on with market research including:

- Education
- Average income
- Lifestyle
- Hobbies and interests
- Occupation
- Marital status
- Platforms
- Devices
- Bio
- Social activity
- Brand affinity
- Challenges
- Goals
- Motivators
- Deterrents
- Content
- Personality traits

Step 6:

You can expand on personality traits without market research you can refer to the Myer-Briggs personality types.

- **ENTJ: The Commander -** Strategic leaders, motivated to organize change
- **INTJ: The Mastermind -** Analytical problem-solvers, eager to improve systems and processes
- **ENTP: The Visionary -** Inspired innovators, seeking new solutions to challenging problems
- **INTP: The Architect -** Philosophical innovators, fascinated by logical analysis
- **ENFJ: The Teacher -** Idealist organizers, driven to do what is best for humanity
- **INFJ: The Counselor -** Creative nurturers, driven by a strong sense of personal integrity
- **ENFP: The Champion -** People-centered creators, motivated by possibilities and potential
- **INFP: The Healer -** Imaginative idealists, guided by their own values and beliefs
- **ESTJ: The Supervisor -** Hardworking traditionalists, taking charge to get things done
- **ISTJ: The Inspector -** Responsible organizers, driven to create order out of chaos
- **ESFJ: The Provider -** Conscientious helpers, dedicated to their duties to others
- **ISFJ: The Protector -** Industrious caretakers, loyal to traditions and institutions
- **ESTP: The Dynamo -** Energetic thrillseekers, ready to push boundaries and dive into action
- **ISTP: The Craftsperson -** Observant troubleshooters, solving practical problems
- **ESFP: The Entertainer -** Vivacious entertainers, loving life and charming those around them
- **ISFP: The Composer -** Gentle caretakers, enjoying the moment with low-key enthusiasm
- View more information on: https://www.16personalities.com/personality-types

Step 8:

Create targeted content from the persona that you have created, post it, test it and perfect it!

Common uses for buyer personas

Bull's eye targeting
You can use your buyer personas to further define your audience as you gather more data about your customers to start bullseye targeting or bulls eye marketing which is when you align your products or services with the consumers who are most likely to purchase them – this is even more niche and specific to segmentation.

Media and channel targeting
You can also use your buyer personas to focus on certain media types and channels for certain segmented audiences.

Product development
You can improve your product or service offering based on what your customers want and need.

Product distribution
You can also improve how you distribute your product based on buyer personas wants and needs – maybe you have a store but you find out that your customers want products delivered to their door.

Communications direction
Buyer personas can help you to understand and empathise with your customer in order to create online communications that they resonate with and that will drive them to purchase your product or service.

Access Templates

Strategy Template
Buyer Persona Template